

Russell Westbrook — The Triple-Double King (2016-17 MVP season)

A basketball-analytics deep dive into **Russell Westbrook's 2016-17 MVP season** — the year he became the **first player since Oscar Robertson (1961-62)** to average a triple-double and set the **single-season triple-double record (42)**.

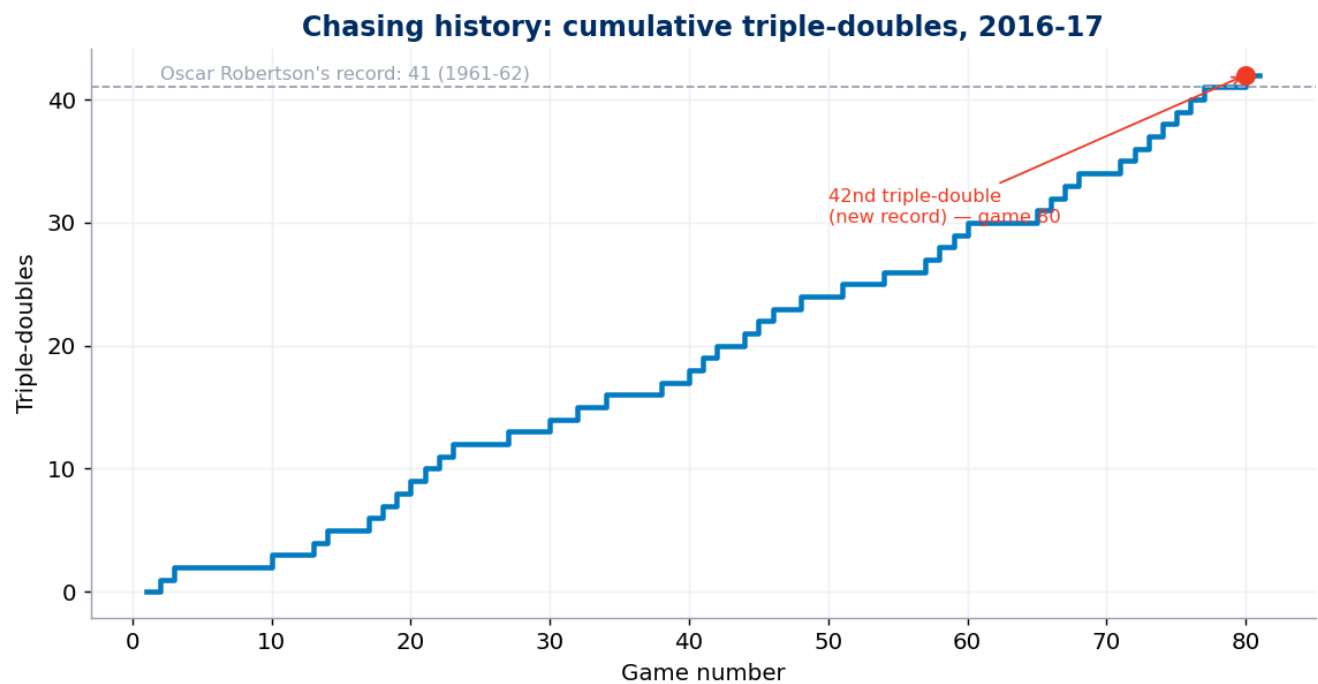
Headline: 31.6 PPG - 10.7 RPG - 10.4 APG across 81 games — a triple-double in **51.9% of games** — and the Thunder won **78.6%** of those games (vs 33.3% without).

Built with a small SQL + Python pipeline. Every number is reproducible by running one command, and the season's famous stats are **validated against the record books** (81 games, 42 triple-doubles, 31.6 / 10.7 / 10.4) before any chart is drawn.

What the data says

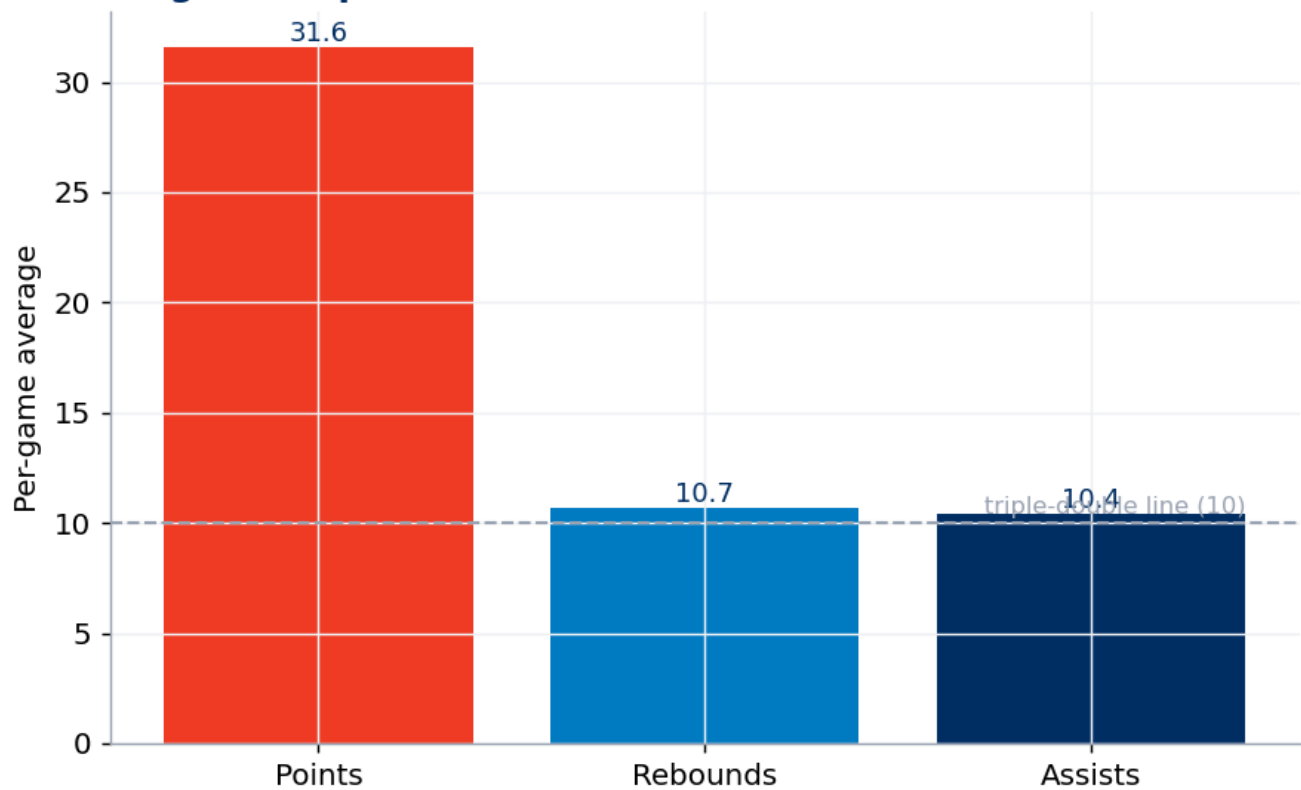
1. Chasing history — 42 triple-doubles

He passed Oscar Robertson's 55-year-old record of 41 in the season's final week.



2. He literally averaged a triple-double

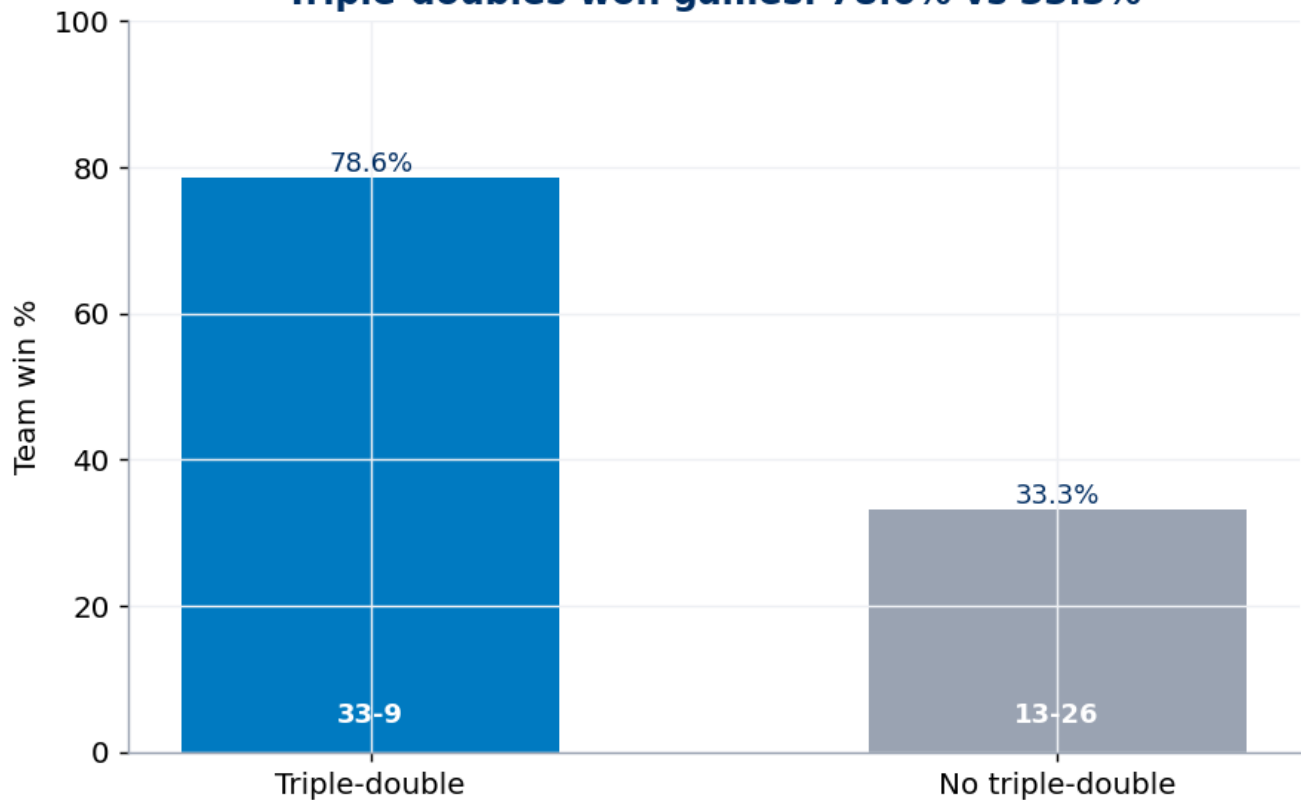
Averaged a triple-double — first since Oscar Robertson (1961-62)



3. The triple-doubles *won* games

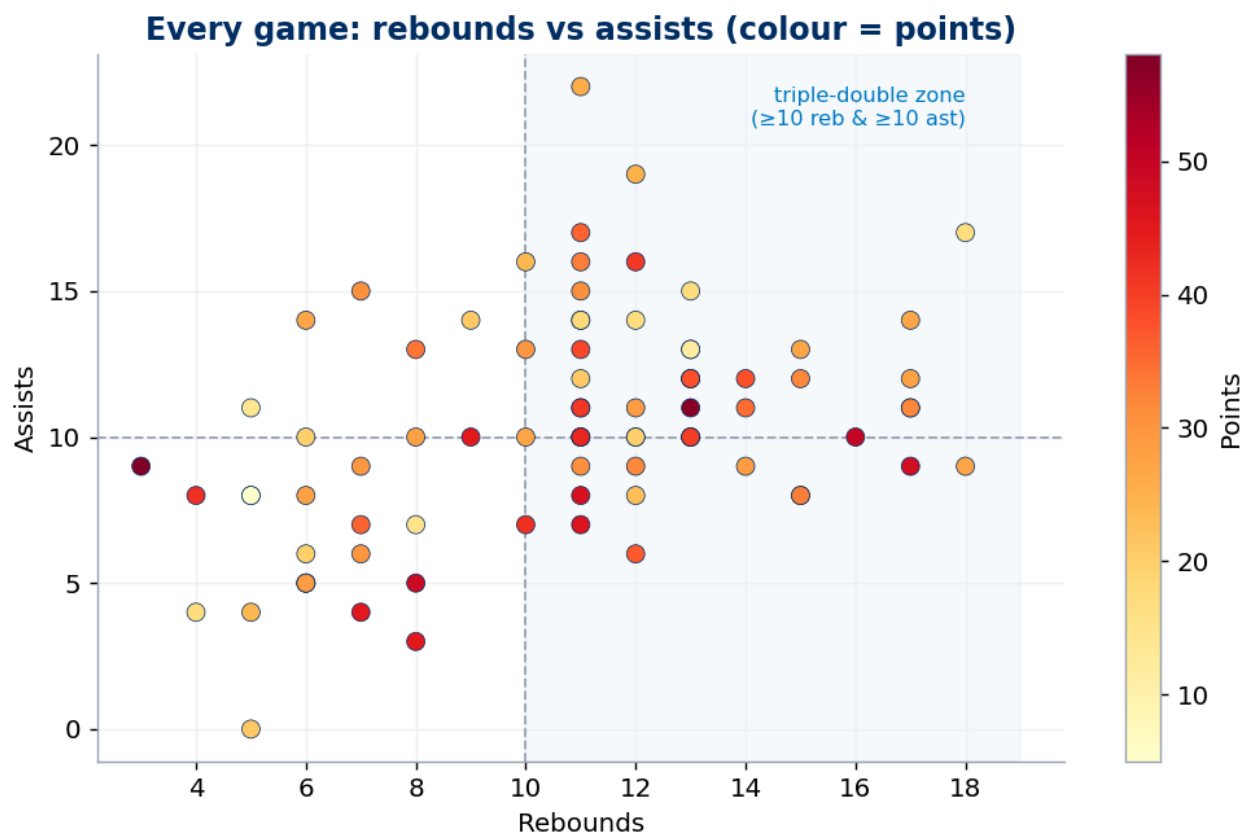
Far from being empty stats, his triple-doubles came with a **78.6% win rate** — more than double the team's win rate in his other games.

Triple-doubles won games: 78.6% vs 33.3%

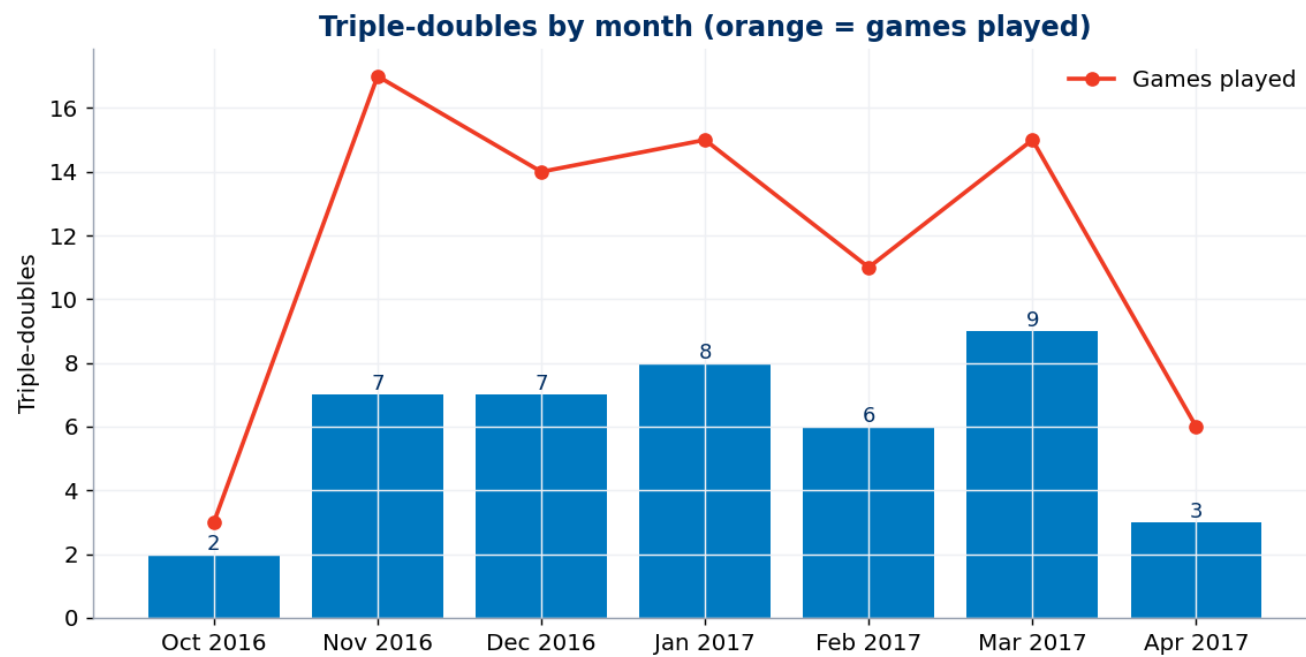


4. Every game, one dot

Rebounds vs assists for all 81 games (colour = points). The top-right quadrant is the triple-double zone — and he lived there.

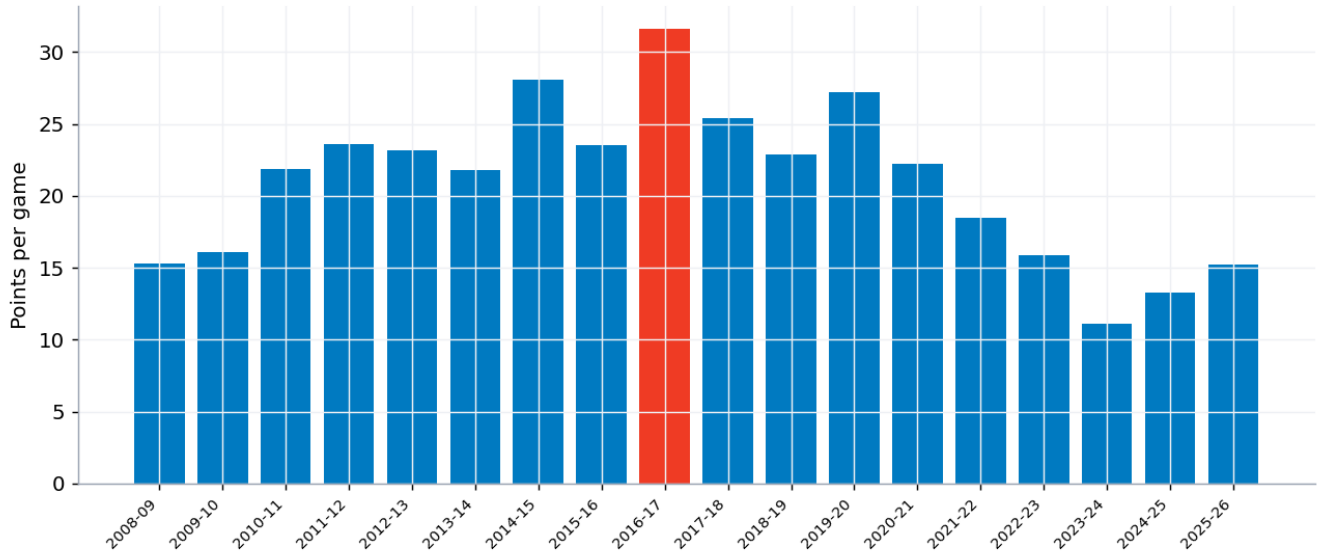


5. Relentless, all season



6. A career scoring peak

Scoring in context: points per game by season (2016-17 in orange)



How it works

```
Basketball-Reference game log    build_dataset.py    westbrook_2016_17_gamelog.csv
                                   (validated vs the record books)

                                   analyze_sql.py (DuckDB SQL)    q_*.csv

                                   viz.py    outputs/*.png
```

- **Data:** Westbrook's 2016-17 game log from [Basketball-Reference](#) — one row per game (points, rebounds, assists, result), parsed with pandas.
- **SQL:** aggregations run on the local CSV via **DuckDB**.
- **Charts:** **matplotlib**, in OKC Thunder colours.

See [SOURCES.md](#) for data provenance.

Run it yourself

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
python run_all.py
```

Regenerates the dataset, the SQL tables (data/processed/) and every chart (outputs/). First run downloads + caches the data; later runs are offline.

Project structure

```
westbrook-mvp-2016-17/
run_all.py          # one command runs the whole pipeline
src/
  common.py         # paths, config, cached HTTP getter
  build_dataset.py  # fetch + clean + validate -> game-log CSV
  analyze_sql.py    # DuckDB SQL aggregations
  viz.py            # matplotlib charts
data/raw/           # cached download
data/processed/     # game-log CSV + query outputs
outputs/            # generated charts (PNG)
```

Caveats

- Single regular season (2016-17); playoffs not included.
- A "triple-double" = double figures (10) in points, rebounds and assists in one game.

Personal basketball-analytics portfolio project. Data: Basketball-Reference (free, public).